Questions and Answers #2
Continental Tires

1) Q. What if the customer has just recently replaced the original equipment tires with new General Grabber AW, or Continental ContiTrac AW tires that fall within the DOT code build date range?

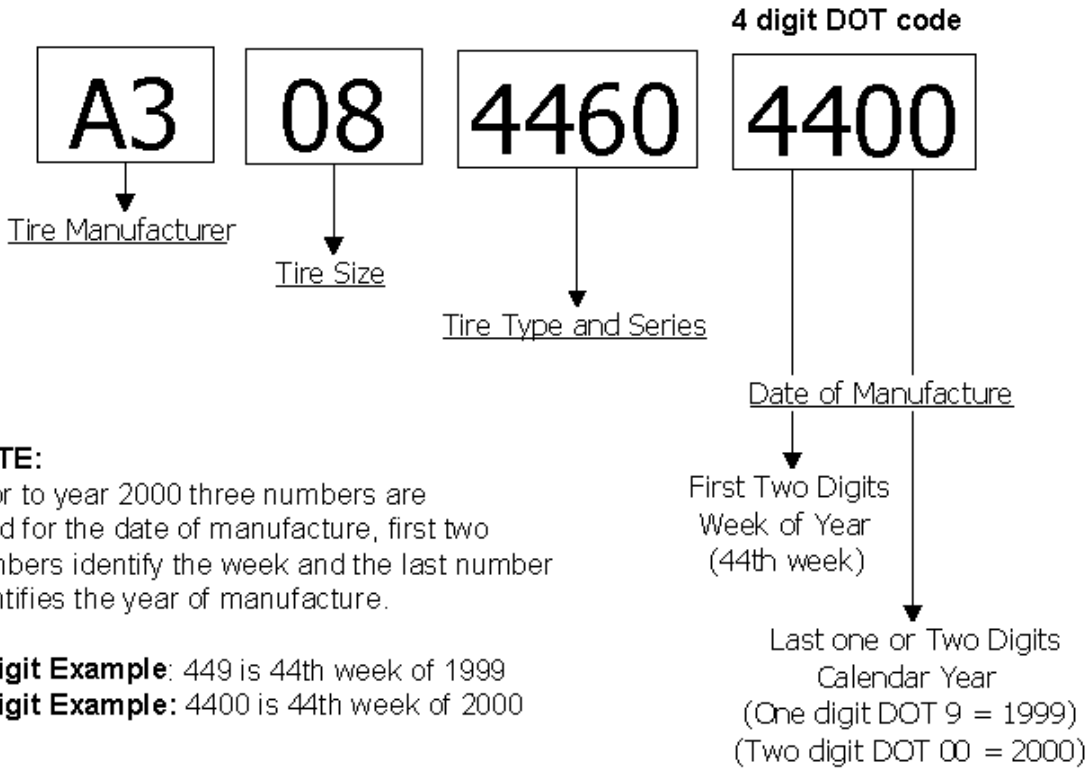
A). All affected tires must be replaced if they fall within the DOT manufacturing date range.

2) Q. Can we inspect tires?

A). Yes, typically failed tires have shown early signs of localized irregular tread wear, predominantly on the inside shoulder. However, both shoulders must be inspected. See illustration at the end of this document.

3) Q. When reading the DOT Code on the tire (DOT Code is used to determine if the tire is affected), where in that code is the information that pertains to the date of manufacture?

A). See chart below: (this is an example of a DOT code)



NOTE:
Prior to year 2000 three numbers are used for the date of manufacture, first two numbers identify the week and the last number identifies the year of manufacture.

3 Digit Example: 449 is 44th week of 1999
4 Digit Example: 4400 is 44th week of 2000

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4) Q. Why is the P265/70R17 tire an acceptable replacement even though it's a different size tire?

A). The P265/70R17 tire passed Ford's ride and handling evaluation, and met Ford's performance standards.

5) Q. If tires are replaced with the P265/70R17's and the P275/60R17's become available, will we be able to install the 275's back on our customers vehicle at no charge?

A). No, tires may only be replaced once under this program.

6) Q. Will additional tires be approved?

A. At this time, the P265/70R17 are the only acceptable replacement tires available through the Tire Hotline. See Q16 regarding the use of P275/60R17 tires not affected by this recall. If additional tires are approved, they will be posted on QCDealer.com under the "Continental Tire Recall" page. A message will also be posted to "What's New".

7) Q. What availability is anticipated for approved replacement tires?

A). Approximately 107,000 vehicles are affected. It is anticipated that up to 400,000 tires may be required to meet the replacement needs of this program.
Additional Continental and General brand replacement tire production will be available through the normal distribution system.

8) Q. What can I do for my customers, if tires are not readily available?

A). Offer to inspect the tires. If there are no signs of abnormal wear patterns on the tire, the tire is less likely to require immediate replacement. Typically failures that we have inspected, have shown an exterior localized wear pattern, mostly on the inside shoulder that is readily visible. Advise the customer to maintain tire pressure, do not overload the vehicle and periodically self inspect the tires for abnormal wear. Customers should be advised to return to the dealer for tire inspection if they subsequently have a tire wear concern. See illustration at the end of this document. If there is abnormal wear, it would be recommended that the additional TAP days be used for these situations, (reference EFC0201209).

9) Q. Are my tires safe to drive on?

A). Tires that show no abnormal exterior wear pattern are less likely to require immediate replacement. If there is abnormal wear, contact your dealer. Until you can get the recall work completed on your vehicle and in order to reduce the chance that a separation will develop, continue to maintain your inflation pressure appropriately, don't over load the vehicle, inspect the tires periodically for wear, and drive safely and responsibly within posted speed limits.

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10) Q. What about non-Expedition/Navigator vehicles that are not listed under 02B01, but have DOT Code confirmed affected tires, are they eligible?

A). If affected tires are found on other products, they were purchased as aftermarket tires. For these non-Expedition/Navigator vehicles that have affected tires, contact the Continental Tire Hotline at 1-800-847-3349.

11) Q. What about 2001 Expedition and Navigator vehicles that are not on OASIS, but have DOT Code confirmed affected tires, are they eligible?

A). If the tires have an affected DOT code and are on an Expedition or Navigator, they are covered, and should be replaced. For Expedition/Navigator vehicles outside of the program, contact the SSSC at 1-800-325-5621 to have the VIN added to the program. To place an Emergency Order for all vehicles, the dealer must contact the Ford Tire Hotline at 1-866-588-6586.

Any vehicles not listed in OASIS, with affected tires requires prior approval from the SSSC for tire replacement. A DOT code for each of the affected tires (including spare) will be required to obtain approval for tire replacement. Please be sure to have the complete DOT codes available for each affected tire at the time you contact the SSSC.

12) Q. The customer currently has black sidewall tires on a Lincoln Navigator. Only white letter replacement tires are available. What should the dealer do?

A). The dealer can contact the Ford Tire Hotline to place an order for black sidewall tires. Due to limited availability, there may be a delay in obtaining black sidewall tires. The Ford Tire Hotline will provide an estimated delivery date for black sidewall replacements.

13) Q. **What do Ford dealers do that are set up as ATW and as a Continental Distributor**? **Do they receive any special, or extra allocations to their supply area?**

A). Order tires through the Ford Tire Hotline process for your customer base only. There are no special allocations at this time. Continental Tire will fill distribution orders as soon as they catch up to demand.

14) Q. When a dealer places an order, how long until he receives his tires?

A). Approximately one to two weeks. Emergency orders will be shipped UPS direct to dealers.

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15) Q. If dealer already replaced the 275 Grabber tires with a 275 Michelin and the spare is still an affected Grabber AW, what does he do, since the tires are a different size?

A). Wait until 275 tires are added to the list. If 275 tires are not added, there will be a future communication instructing how to replace the spare tire.

16) Q. Can Contitrac AW 275/60R17 or Grabber AW with higher DOT #'s than the recalled tires be used as replacements?

A). Yes, tires produced after the specified date range are not affected by this recall program. Of course, never mix tire sizes anywhere on the vehicle. (Tires used must be from the approved tire list in Attachment II. Other variations of the Grabber AW or Contitrac AW are not approved for use on these vehicles.)

17) Q. What is the difference between the 2003 Continental tire and the recalled tire?

A). The 2003 Continental tire used on the Expedition and Navigator is a completely new design tire.

18) Q. What about vehicles with branded titles, are they eligible?

A). Although normally excluded from Ford Owner Notified Actions, all vehicles with affected tires, (confirmed by inspecting the DOT Code), are eligible for the Continental Tire Recall.

19) Q. Were these tires (Conti Trac AW or General Grabber AW P275 60 R17) used as replacement tires under the Firestone Recall?

A) This was not an approved tire under either Firestone program.

20) Q. In previous recall programs, four road tires could be replaced on a vehicle and as more tires came available, the customer could return to have the spare replaced. The spare tire would then be claimed as a related damage claim. How are dealers able to claim the spare tire for this program?

A). We recommend that all five tires be replaced at once.

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21) Q. Will AtW/Ford Tire Program dealers be indemnified if a customer comes in to a Ford dealership with affected tires on their vehicle and the dealer determines that they are safe until replacement tires are available and the tires subsequently fail. Who is responsible?

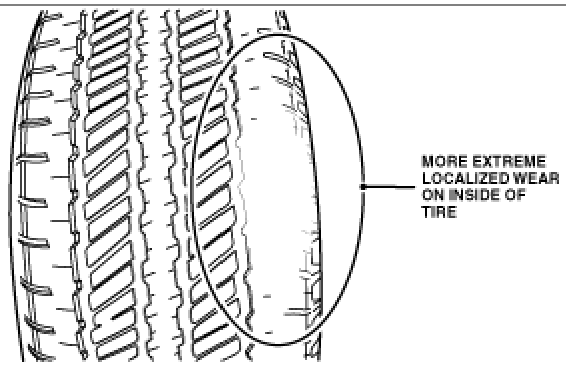
A). Ford is not providing any additional indemnification under this recall beyond the existing agreements that we already have with our dealers. Dealers should notify the customer the tires are affected and make sure the tires are inflated to the recommended tire pressure. Additionally, the customer should be informed that tire maintenance, tire over loading and speed impact tire performance. Until they can get the recall work completed, they should take extra care to maintain their tires appropriately and drive responsibly. If the tires show abnormal wear, it would be recommended that the additional TAP days be utilized and place the customer in another vehicle.

22) Q. What if a customer returns a 2000/2001 two-wheel drive Expedition or Navigator with affected tires that claims a failed tire has caused damage to the vehicle.

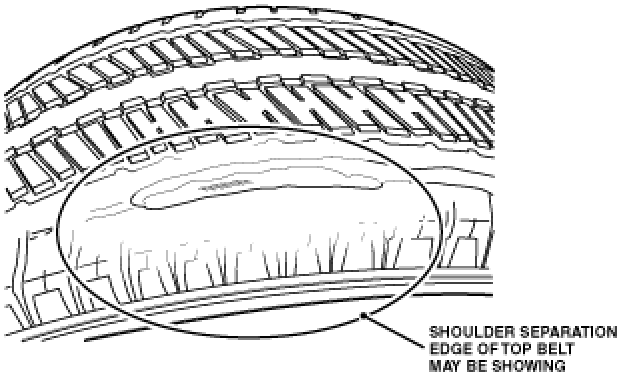
A). Replace all the tires covered under the recall program. Inform the customer to maintain possession of the tire that allegedly caused damage to the vehicle. Have the customer contact Continental Tire Customer Relations at 1-800-847-3349. Continental Tire will work with the customer directly to resolve the claim.

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CONTINENTAL TIRE INSPECTION



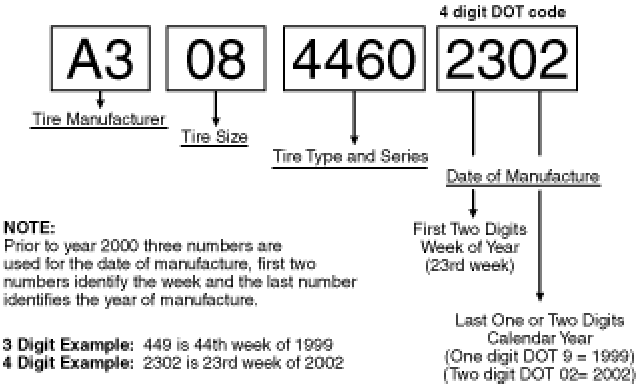
CUSTOMERS MAY EXPERIENCE A CHANGE IN THE NOISE AND VIBRATION OF THEIR VEHICLE DUE TO THIS LOCALIZED WEAR



CUSTOMERS MAY EXPERIENCE A CHANGE IN THE NOISE AND VIBRATION OF THEIR VEHICLE DUE TO THIS LOCALIZED WEAR

NOTE: Be sure to check both shoulders of the tire for wear.

DECODER EXAMPLE



NOTE:
Prior to year 2000 three numbers are used for the date of manufacture, first two numbers identify the week and the last number identifies the year of manufacture.

3 Digit Example: 449 is 44th week of 1999
4 Digit Example: 2302 is 23rd week of 2002

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